

Grouping pages, round 2

Five pages drafted on 29 September 2026 to the pattern of the Mingei, Nok and Igun Eronmwon pages in F1 Groundwork. Each cites canon IDs, gives both readings where a claim is argued, and lists only open objects whose records were read.

Grouping page: The Indian Ocean

A wind that reverses twice a year let printers in Gujarat, potters in Zhejiang and builders at Kilwa work for buyers they never met.

Card

Part	Content
Kind	Network: a set of sea routes, ports and merchant communities, not a state or a people (NET005, the umbrella row; sub-circuits NET006 Arabian Sea, NET007 Bay of Bengal, NET008 South China Sea)
Defined by (who, when)	Named from outside and after the fact. The <i>Periplus of the Erythraean Sea</i> (mid-1st century CE, a Greek-Egyptian merchant; TXT073) described its western half port by port. Historians made "the Indian Ocean world" a unit of study in the late 20th century; the canon row names K. N. Chaudhuri and Abdul Sheriff (not re-checked here). The sailors, merchants and makers inside it used their own names for seas and routes
Span	c. 2500 BCE (Harappan–Gulf contact, canon) to the present. This walk runs from the 1st century CE to 2011, with most steps between c. 800 and 1500 CE
Places	The East African coast from Shanga to Kilwa; the Red Sea and Aden; the Gulf (Siraf, Hormuz); Gujarat and the Malabar coast (Calicut, Mangalore); the Straits (Malacca); the south China coast (Quanzhou)

Part	Content
Membership confidence	Documented for ports, excavated finds and letters. Probable for most routes: a sherd found at Kilwa shows where a bowl ended, not the ships it took. Contested for who carried the trade and who profited
Leaves out	The inland miners, hunters and farmers who supplied gold, ivory and grain; the sailors and caulkers; the printers and dyers, almost never named; women, who appear mostly through men's letters; the people who were enslaved and forcibly moved along the same routes, whom the old sources list among cargo
Rights line	Objects: Met Open Access (public domain where <code>isPublicDomain</code> is true) and Cleveland Open Access (CC0) textiles and ceramics may be shown. Geniza manuscripts: link out to the holder; the Princeton Geniza Project page text is CC BY 2.0, images are not. Belitung cargo: link out only (commercial salvage). British Museum Kilwa and Swahili material: link out only (non-commercial). Lenj: link out to UNESCO; per-photo licences. No image of enslaved people is shown without a content note and its source's framing

Walk

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
1	The wind that turns	Sailors timed their year to a wind that blows one way, then the other. Over the Arabian Sea the southwest monsoon runs from about June to September; the northeast monsoon blows in winter. The <i>Periplus</i> credits a pilot, Hippalus, with laying a course "straight across the ocean" (§57).	NET005, NET006, TXT073	Wind timing: documented. That Hippalus found the route: contested (see What is argued)
2	A ship sewn together	Shipwrights stitched this hull plank to plank with cord, without nails. It sank off Belitung, Indonesia, in about the 830s. Michael Flecker found "every timber was fastened with stitching", in African <i>Afzelia</i> planks with teak through-beams from India.	PLC248, TEC143, OBT295, MAT095	Construction and timbers: documented (Flecker). That it was built in the western Indian Ocean: probable

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
3	Seven ports, seven towns	Ports were towns where people settled, married and prayed, not only stops. Siraf served the Abbasid Gulf; excavations from 1966 found a "massive haul" of Chinese and Islamic pottery. Aden, Calicut, Hormuz and Malacca each held one sea gate; Quanzhou's Qingjing Mosque and a statue of Mani show a mixed merchant town.	PLC277, PLC294, PLC221, PLC278, PLC245, PLC190, PLC076	Documented (Whitehouse's excavations; UNESCO 2021 for Quanzhou). Dates for Aden, Calicut, Hormuz and Malacca are the canon's, approximate
4	Cloth printed for Cairo	Printers and dyers in Gujarat stamped this cotton for buyers in Egypt. The fragments were dug from rubbish mounds near Fustat in the 1920s and 1930s. Radiocarbon dates in the Ashmolean's Newberry collection run from about 1010 CE (± 55) to the late 1600s.	NET055, MAT056, PLC003; Met 30.112.40; Met 30.112.28; Cleveland 1951.516	Made in Gujarat, found at Fustat: documented (museum attributions; Barnes). Workshops and names of makers: not known

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
5	Bowls set into walls	Potters in China made glazed bowls and dishes that reached the Swahili coast. Twenty sherds of 9th-century Changsha ware came from Shanga; Longquan greenware and Jingdezhen blue-and-white followed. From the 13th century, Swahili builders set such bowls into the façades of pillar and dome tombs.	OBT070, TEC034, NET009, NET054, NET012, NET011, PLC076, CIV004; Cleveland 1964.164	Finds and dates: documented (Carfantan; UNESCO Kilwa). What the bowls meant to their owners: we read them as display and, from oral tradition, protection (interpretive). Tombs are described, not shown
6	A merchant's letters	Abraham Ben Yiju, born in Ifriqiya about 1100, was trading from Mangalore by 1132. He ran a bronze workshop and sent pepper, cardamom and brass bowls to his partner Madmun in Aden. On 17 October 1132 he freed an enslaved woman, Ashu; she took the name Berakha.	PER326, TXT067, DOC-001, DIA004, TXT066, PLC294	Letters, trade and the deed: documented (Goitein; Princeton Geniza Project). That Ashu became his wife: probable (most specialists). Her own voice: not recorded

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
7	Families across the water	Merchant families lived on both shores for generations. Gujarati traders ran cloth, beads and credit and settled in Malacca, Mombasa and Zanzibar; Tomé Pires recorded them in Malacca c. 1512–15. By the mid-1930s the Hadrami diaspora numbered about 110,000, a third of all Hadramis.	DIA006, DIA005, COM061, PLC245	Documented. The 1930s figure: documented as cited (Wikipedia after Engseng Ho, 2006)
8	People moved by force	<i>Content note: enslavement.</i> Enslavers moved people across this ocean from at least the 1st century CE into the 1800s. The <i>Periplus</i> lists enslaved people beside cloth and grain (§13, §31, §36); we name them as people. In lower Iraq, enslaved workers cleared salt-crusted land and rose in revolt (869–883); Zanzibar's slave market closed in 1873.	COM203, PLC080, POL011, TXT073, NET005	Documented. Who the rebels of 869–883 were: contested. Numbers moved across the ocean: not known with any precision

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
9	A lenj on the slipway	Shipwrights on Iran's Gulf coast still build wooden lenj by hand. UNESCO inscribed the skills of building and sailing them in 2011, on its Urgent Safeguarding list. Navigators read the sun, moon and stars and named each wind; in 2011 the practitioners were few and mostly older.	PRA143 (project PR-011), TEC144, OBT295; PRA023 (Swahili jahazi building)	Documented, dated to UNESCO's 2011 file. Present number of yards: not known to us

Members. This walk lights 10 networks and diasporas, 11 places, 3 people, 5 texts, 5 techniques and object types, 3 materials, 2 communities, 2 practices and 4 open objects. Networks and diasporas: the Indian Ocean world (NET005), the Arabian Sea circuit (NET006), the Nanhai route (NET009), the Kilwa gold route (NET011), Swahili dhow trade (NET012), the porcelain trade (NET054), the Indian cotton textile trade (NET055), Geniza merchants (DIA004), the Hadrami diaspora (DIA005) and Gujarati merchant communities (DIA006). Places: Siraf, Aden, Calicut, Hormuz, Malacca, Quanzhou, Kilwa Kisiwani, Fustat, Zanzibar Stone Town, the Belitung wreck and, through the letters, Mangalore (no canon row). People: Abraham Ben Yiju (PER326); Ashu, named in his deed but with no row of her own; Ibn Battuta (PER325), who visited Kilwa in 1331. Texts: the *Periplus* (TXT073), the Geniza documents (TXT066), Ben Yiju's letters and accounts (TXT067, project DOC-001), the Kilwa Chronicle (TXT048) and the *Rihla* (TXT072). Techniques and types: sewn-plank boat building (TEC143), dhow building (TEC144), celadon (TEC034), the dhow (OBT295) and the celadon bowl (OBT070). Materials: cotton (MAT056), teak (MAT095), coir (MAT069, for stitching; not confirmed for Belitung). Communities: Waswahili (COM061) and Siddi (COM203). Practices: lenj building and sailing (PRA143) and Swahili dhow building (PRA023). The Swahili coast (CIV004) is a civilisation label that opens onto these rows; it is not a member ranked above them.

Neighbours. Overland, the Silk Roads (NET001) carried some of the same silk and ceramics by relay. The Red Sea network (NET032) and medieval Mediterranean trade (NET023) joined it at Aden and Fustat; the Geniza merchants worked in both. At its

eastern end it meets the Nanhai route (NET009) and the Chinese maritime diaspora (DIA007). From 1498 the Cape Route and the East India companies (NET033) cut into it by force. Vasco da Gama reached Calicut that year (OCC053); Portuguese forces sacked Kilwa and Mombasa in 1505 (OCC054). Parallels elsewhere: trans-Saharan trade (NET010), which also moved gold, cloth and cowries (NET013); the transatlantic trafficking of enslaved Africans (NET035), which was larger in scale and shorter in span; Austronesian voyaging (NET045), which reached Madagascar across the same ocean.

Afterlives. The word "calico" is named after Calicut (canon PLC221). Kilwa Kisiwani and Songo Mnara were inscribed as World Heritage in 1981; Quanzhou followed in 2021 as "Emporium of the World in Song-Yuan China". The Belitung cargo was sold to Singapore's Sentosa Leisure Group in 2005 for US\$32 million; the Smithsonian cancelled its exhibition in 2011. Siraf is now under the village of Taheri and near oil and gas works (Current World Archaeology, undated web page). The Siddi descend from East Africans who came as soldiers, sailors, merchants and enslaved people. The 2011 census counted 10,477 in Karnataka and 8,661 in Gujarat. In 2011 UNESCO recorded that fibreglass boats were replacing wooden lenj and that yards were turning to repair work. "Maritime Silk Road" is the name many governments and tourist boards now use for these routes (canon other names).

What is argued.

- *Who found the monsoon route?* The *Periplus* (§57) credits the Greek pilot Hippalus with learning to cross open water. Other readings hold that Arabian Sea sailors trading between Africa, India and Southeast Asia knew the pattern long before (Wikipedia, "Monsoon of South Asia"). We show the Greek text as one outsider's claim.
- *Whose coast?* Colonial-era writers framed the Swahili towns as "Arab" or "Persian" colonies. African archaeology since the 1960s reads them as African towns working in Indian Ocean trade (canon CIV004, naming Chittick, Horton and Chami). The Chinese bowls in tomb façades support the second reading: local builders chose where they went (Carfantan).
- *What was the revolt of 869–883?* One reading: a rising of enslaved East Africans, "Zanj", against Abbasid landowners. Ghada Talhami and M. A. Shaban argue it was a wider uprising of the poor, with free Africans, Bedouin and peasants (Wikipedia, "Zanj Rebellion"). Both are shown.
- *Should a salvaged cargo be shown?* The Smithsonian judged that showing the Belitung finds would condone "commercial exploitation of unscientifically excavated objects". Singapore and Indonesia read the cancellation as a slight (Trafficking Culture). The Atlas links out and states the salvage history.

Apply (F1.13 Networks; links to F1.6, F1.9 and F1.10)

- **Maker (M).** The Met's 14th-century Gujarati print (30.112.28) copies woven silk patterns from Iran and Egypt in stamped, mordant-dyed cotton. Design up to three blocks that give a costly surface through a cheaper process, for a buyer in another country. Note what your process can and cannot copy, and write a maker's credit for the printer.
- **Briefer (B).** Write a one-page order from Madmun in Aden to a workshop in Mangalore for bronze bowls. Set the deadline by the sailing season, not a calendar date. Name who carries the risk if the ship is lost. Name the workshop's makers, even as "the casters of Ben Yiju's workshop", and state what you do not know about them.

Candidate open objects

Holder and ID	What it is	Date range	Licence as stated	1970 provenance status	Record
The Met, 30.112.40	Textile fragment with chevron pattern; made in India, Gujarat; found near Fustat, Egypt	13th-14th century	Public domain (isPublicDomain: true)	Purchased 1930 (V. Everit Macy Gift); provenance "Found near Fustat, Egypt": pre-1970	Met 448534
The Met, 30.112.28	Textile with arabesque and palmette design; block-printed, mordant-dyed cotton; made in Gujarat, found near Fustat	14th century	Public domain (isPublicDomain: true)	Purchased 1930: pre-1970	Met 448522
Cleveland Museum of Art, 1951.516	Fragment with decorated bands; cotton, stamped resist and dyed; India, Gujarat	probably 1400s	CC0	"found at Fostat in Egypt; [Group F, Pfister ... (Paris, 1938)]; (Adolph Loewi)"; purchased 1951: pre-1970	clevelandart.org/art/1951.516

Holder and ID	What it is	Date range	Licence as stated	1970 provenance status	Record
Cleveland Museum of Art, 1929.845	Fragment, block printing on cotton; Egypt, Mamluk sultanate. Local printers using the Indian method, with fish motifs	1200s–1300s	CC0	Paul Mallon, Paris, sold to the museum 1929: pre-1970	clevelandart.org/art/1929.845
Cleveland Museum of Art, 1964.164	Dish with two fish in relief, Longquan ware, Zhejiang. Stands for the type; this dish has no East African findspot	mid-1200s	CC0	Record gives no acquisition history; accessioned 1964 (gift of Severance A. Millikin)	clevelandart.org/art/1964.164
Princeton Geniza Project, record of IOM D 55.10 (held by the Institute of Oriental Manuscripts, Russian Academy of Sciences)	Deed of manumission for Ashu, written by Ben Yiju in Mangalore. <i>Content note: enslavement</i>	17 October 1132	Page text CC BY 2.0; no image on the page; manuscript image rights sit with the holder	Not applicable (archive document); holder's acquisition history not stated	geniza.princeton.edu/documents/5501
The Met, 2002.448	Oval bowl, Changsha ware, the type carried on the Belitung ship	8th–9th century	Public domain (<code>isPublicDomain: true</code>)	Gift 2002; no earlier history published. Hold until provenance is checked, given the Belitung salvage market	Met 65101

No open-licensed object with an East African findspot was found in the Met, Cleveland or AIC collections. For step 5 we propose the Cleveland dish as a type, a drawing of our own of a tomb façade with inset bowls (from published plans, not photographs of graves), and a link out to excavation reports. For step 9 we propose a link out to UNESCO's lenj page, or our own photographs, taken with a yard's consent.

Sources

- [Made in India, Found in Egypt: Red Sea Textile Trade in the Thirteenth and Fourteenth Centuries \(Met, Ayesha U. Shaikh, 2023\)](#)
- [Indian Block-Printed Textiles in Egypt: The Newberry Collection \(Ashmolean, Ruth Barnes\)](#)
- [Met object 30.112.40](#)
- [Met object 30.112.28](#)
- [Met object 2002.448](#)
- [Cleveland Open Access API, 1951.516](#)
- [Cleveland Open Access API, 1929.845](#)
- [Cleveland Open Access API, 1964.164](#)
- [Ruins of Kilwa Kisiwani and Ruins of Songo Mnara \(UNESCO\)](#)
- [Quanzhou: Emporium of the World in Song-Yuan China \(UNESCO\)](#)
- [Traditional skills of building and sailing Iranian Lenj boats in the Persian Gulf \(UNESCO ICH\)](#)
- [A Ninth-Century Arab Shipwreck in Indonesia \(Michael Flecker, Smithsonian\)](#)
- [Belitung Shipwreck \(Trafficking Culture\)](#)
- [Chinese Porcelain and Ceramics from the East African Coast \(Caroline Carfantan, SEACS\)](#)
- [Siraf, Iran \(Current World Archaeology\)](#)
- [Periplus of the Erythraean Sea \(ToposText, Schoff translation\)](#)
- [Legal document IOM D 55.10 \(Princeton Geniza Project\)](#)
- Wikipedia, for simple facts only: [Monsoon of South Asia](#); [Abraham Ben Yiju](#); [Hadhrami diaspora](#); [Tomé Pires](#); [Zanj Rebellion](#); [Siddi](#); [Construction of Iranian Lenj boats](#)

Grouping page: Indus Valley civilisation

Brick drains, chert weights and carved seals, about 2600–1900 BCE: a modern name gathers them, and nobody knows what their makers called themselves.

Card

Part	Content
Kind	Civilisation, as commonly named (CIV048). It is a search label that opens onto the Harappan archaeological cultures beneath it. It is not a self-name, and the Atlas does not rank it against other civilisations
Defined by (who, when)	John Marshall and the Archaeological Survey of India, announced in the <i>Illustrated London News</i> in September 1924. "Harappan" comes from the type site, Harappa. Archaeologists and museums in Pakistan, India and elsewhere use both names. "Sindhu-Sarasvati civilisation" is used mainly by supporters of Indigenous Aryanism and is politically contested. Jim Shaffer (1992) recast the whole as an "Indus Tradition" of eras (PRD142)
Span	About 3300–1300 BCE (canon, approximate). Beneath it: Early Harappan about 3300–2600 BCE (ARC138), Mature Harappan about 2600–1900 BCE (ARC139), Late Harappan about 1900–1300 BCE (ARC140). Earlier farming villages such as Mehrgarh (ARC137) sit before it, not inside it
Places	The Indus and Ghaggar-Hakra plains, with Gujarat and the Balochistan edges; today Pakistan and northwest India. Cities: Harappa (PLC215), Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Lothal (PLC216); craft town Chanhudaro. By 2002 over 1,000 Mature Harappan settlements had been reported, just under a hundred excavated
Membership confidence	Documented for finds excavated at named sites. Probable for museum seals labelled only "Indus Valley", which are attributed by style. Contested at the edges: hinterland villages, and whether Late Harappan communities still belong

Part	Content
Leaves out	Its makers' own name and language, since the signs are unread. Whether the signs are writing at all. The farmers, herders and hill communities of Balochistan and the hinterland. Its neighbours in Dilmun, Magan, the Helmand and the Oxus. Present-day people of Sindh, Punjab, Gujarat and Haryana. The Late phases, often told as "collapse"
Rights line	Met and Cleveland records listed below are CC0 or public domain and may be shown. One CC0 Commons photograph shows weights in the National Museum, New Delhi. Harappa.com images are © Harappa.com: link out only. Objects in Pakistan's and India's national collections: link out unless the holder licenses. Burials at Harappa and Rakhigarhi, and all human remains, are never shown

Walk

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
1	A drain in a Mohenjo-daro street	Walk a Mohenjo-daro street and a covered brick drain runs beside you. Builders laid streets at right angles, with baked-brick houses, wells and soak pits for sewage. No palace or royal tomb has been identified there.	CIV048; ARC139; TEC155 (fired brick); Mohenjo-daro (no canon ID; proposed)	Planning, drains and soak pits: documented (UNESCO). No identified palace: documented as an absence, not proof of equality

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
2	Bricks under a railway	Harappa's mounds were known, and quarried for bricks, long before archaeologists came. Charles Masson described Harappa after travelling in Punjab from 1829. In the mid-1850s, Harappan bricks were laid under about 160 km of Multan-Lahore railway track. Daya Ram Sahni dug there from about 1921; Marshall announced the finds in 1924.	PLC215; CIV048	Documented. We name the brick-taking plainly: the site was damaged for colonial railway building
3	Reservoirs at Dholavira, mounds at Rakhigarhi	At Dholavira, in Kachchh, builders cut sixteen or more reservoirs into stone. UNESCO dates occupation to about 3000-1500 BCE and records bead, shell and metal workshops. Rakhigarhi's eleven mounds are put at about 350 hectares; critics say the figure joins separate settlements.	Dholavira, Rakhigarhi (no canon IDs; proposed); ARC138-ARC140	Reservoirs and workshops: documented. Rakhigarhi as "the largest" site: contested. Cities differ: Dholavira builds in stone, Mohenjo-daro in brick

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
4	A chert cube on a balance pan	A small chert cube sits on a balance pan. Weights at Harappa double from 0.856 g in a 1:2:4:8:16:32 series; the commonest is about 13.7 g. Above that the steps become decimal, and the same system turns up across the settlements.	OBT165; INV173; PRD142; Commons photo (National Museum, New Delhi)	System and values: documented (Harappa.com captions). Use for trade and perhaps taxes: probable, not recorded
5	A seal cutter's one-horned animal	A seal cutter carved a one-horned animal into a square of steatite. The finished seal was fired: the Met describes Met 49.40.1 as "burnt steatite". Seals were probably pressed into clay to mark goods or property.	OBT126; MAT009; Met 49.40.1; Met 49.40.2; Cleveland 1964.104	Making: documented. Use: probable ("likely employed to identify merchandise or property", Cleveland). What the animal and the object before it meant: interpretive; the Met reads the object as possibly an altar or incense burner

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
6	Five signs nobody can read	Above the animal runs a short line of signs nobody can yet read. About 5,000 inscriptions are known, averaging about five signs, with 400 to about 700 distinct signs estimated. At Dholavira ten signs, each about 37 cm high, were set on a board by the north gateway.	INV006 (links to F1.5); Met 49.40.4 (signs only); Dholavira	Counts: documented as estimates. Is it writing? Contested: Farmer, Sproat and Witzel (2004) argued the signs are non-linguistic emblems; Rao and colleagues (2009) argued their statistics sit closer to languages
7	A bead driller at Chanhudaro	At Chanhudaro in 1935–36, excavators found beads at every stage of making. Makers struck long slips of stone, flaked and ground them, then bored them with stone drills. Kenoyer links these hard-stone drills to the long, slender carnelian beads; shell workers sawed conch into bangles.	MAT006 (carnelian); MAT082 (conch shell); TEC043 (faience); Chanhudaro (no canon ID; proposed); PLC216 (Lothal bead workshop)	Stages and drills: documented (Mackay's report). Who organised the work, households or a central authority: argued (see below)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
8	A carnelian bead at Nippur	A carnelian bead catalogued as Indus work was excavated at Nippur, Iraq, in 1957–58. Akkadian texts name Meluhha, and most specialists place it in the Indus region. Sargon's inscription says ships from Meluhha, Magan and Dilmun tied up at the quay of Agade.	NET016; CIV060; CIV061; PLC289; PLC265; Met 59.41.42	Bead and text: documented. Meluhha as the Indus region: probable (scholarly consensus, not a self-name). Lothal's basin as a dock for this trade: contested
9	A painted bowl from the hills	Potters at Damb Sadaat, in Balochistan, made this bowl outside the cities' reach. The Met reads its shape and painting as showing contact with the Indus cities in the 3rd millennium BCE. After about 1900 BCE the large cities shrank and settlement moved east; the causes are argued.	Met 57.99.2; ARC137; PLC214; CIV070; CIV089; ARC140; PRD093	Bowl and contact: documented. After 1900 BCE: we do not tell a "rise and fall". Shrinking cities are documented; the cause is contested

Members. In the canon: 1 civilisation name (CIV048); 3 archaeological cultures (ARC138 Early, ARC139 Mature, ARC140 Late Harappan); 1 period scheme (PRD142, Shaffer's eras); 2 places (PLC215 Harappa, PLC216 Lothal), with 4 more proposed (Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Chanhudaro); 2 object types (OBT126 stamp seal, OBT165 Indus weights); 3 "earliest known" rows (INV006 Indus script, INV173 standard weights, INV099 wild silk); 4 materials (MAT006 carnelian, MAT009 steatite, MAT082 conch shell, MAT022

faience); 2 techniques (TEC155 fired brick, TEC043 faience). Eight open items: four Met seals, one Cleveland seal, the Nippur bead, the Damb Sadaat bowl and a photographed set of weights. The key members are the seals, the weights and the carnelian beads, because they travel between every city.

Neighbours. Before it: the farming village of Mehrgarh (ARC137, PLC214). Around it: hill communities of Balochistan (Damb Sadaat), the Helmand craft town of Shahr-i Sokhta (CIV070, PLC273), and the Oxus towns (CIV089, ARC104). Across the sea, through NET016: Dilmun (CIV060, POL099, PLC289), Magan and the Umm an-Nar communities (CIV061, ARC061, PLC292), and Mesopotamia, where Indus carnelian reached Ur (PLC265, PER279). After it: Late Harappan regional crafts (ARC140) and the Vedic period (PRD143), whose link to the Indus heritage is argued and politically charged. Parallel names elsewhere, with no ranking: Dilmun, Magan, Helmand and Oxus are also "civilisations as commonly named" in the canon.

Afterlives. Bead-making in Khambhat (Cambay), Gujarat, still works agate and carnelian. Kenoyer, Vidale and Bhan recorded it in 1989 and 1990: heating nodules, chipping, sawing, grinding, diamond-tipped drilling and polishing. Merchant families ran the workshops; Bhil labourers mined the stone; women strung the beads. They used this to argue that standard products need not mean state control. "Agates of Cambay" was registered as an Indian Geographical Indication in 2008 (Culture and Heritage, 2023). That page also reports silicosis among workers and dates the Muslim bead trade to Baba Ghor, about 1500 CE. In 2023 ThePrint profiled Anwar Husain Shaikh, a fifth-generation bead-maker who hand-drills Harappan-style beads. Its claim that today's makers descend from Harappan craftsmen is not evidenced; the continuity shown is of stone and technique. Remembered: Mohenjo-daro became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1980, Dholavira in 2021. Sold: museum shops and brands reuse the "unicorn" seal; Cleveland's own wall text still calls the sites "mysterious", which this page does not repeat.

What is argued.

- *Are the signs writing?* Farmer, Sproat and Witzel (2004) argue they are non-linguistic emblems: texts average 4.6 signs, the longest single surface has 17, and frequent signs rarely repeat within a text. Rao and colleagues (2009) argue the signs' conditional entropy is closer to natural languages than to non-linguistic systems. Both sides still publish; no decipherment is accepted.
- *What happened after about 1900 BCE?* Giosan and colleagues (2012) link shrinking and eastward-moving settlement to river and monsoon change, and use the word "collapse". Petrie (2019) stresses the cities' long resilience, notes that "different social,

economic and political structures" were in place by about 1900 BCE, and calls the causal data inconclusive. Shaffer's scheme (PRD142) names it "Localisation", not collapse.

- *Was Lothal's basin a dock?* S. R. Rao, its excavator, argued a dockyard. Leshnik (1968) and Yule (1982) argued a water tank, since the inlet seems too narrow for sea-going boats. Later finds of foraminifera and salt crystals suggest seawater once filled it.
- *Who ran the cities?* No palaces or royal tombs are identified. Petrie argues several elite groups of roughly equal standing, with ways of limiting concentrated power. Kenoyer, Vidale and Bhan's Khambhat study warns that standard beads and weights can come from many workshops, not only from a state.

Apply (F1.5, where the canon routes INV006 and INV173; also F1.9)

- **Maker (M).** Write the label for Met 49.40.1 in three tiers, each true on its own. Show the signs but do not translate them; say who made the seal, what is known, and what is argued.
- **Briefer (B).** Write the brief clause for a brand borrowing Indus motifs. Ban "lost civilisation" and invented translations; require the holder, licence and 1970 status of any seal image; name Pakistan and India as the source countries.

Candidate open objects

#	Holder and ID	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence (as holder states)	1970 provenance status	Record
1	The Met, 49.40.1	Stamp seal and modern impression: unicorn and incense burner (?); burnt steatite	ca. 2600–1900 BCE (Mature Harappan)	Public domain (<code>isPublicDomain: true</code>)	Passes: "1902–1934, acquired by John H. Marshall from the Montgomery district of the Punjab Province of British India"; bought from Marshall 1949. Colonial-context flag: Marshall headed the survey that dug Harappa, which sits in that district, so the page shows this history with the seal	Met 324062
2	The Met, 49.40.2	Stamp seal: buffalo with incense burner (?); steatite, burnt, glazed	ca. 2600–1900 BCE	Public domain	Passes: same Marshall history, acquired 1949; same flag	Met 324063
3	The Met, 49.40.3	Stamp seal fragment: unicorn and incense burner (?), inscription	ca. 2600–1900 BCE	Public domain	Passes: same Marshall history, acquired 1949; same flag	Met 324064
4	The Met, 49.40.4	Bar-shaped rectangular plaque seal (signs only); steatite	3rd millennium BCE	Public domain	Passes: same Marshall history, acquired 1949; same flag	Met 324065

#	Holder and ID	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence (as holder states)	1970 provenance status	Record
5	Cleveland Museum of Art, 1964.104	Seal with unicorn and inscription; "possibly kaolin"	c. 2000 BCE	CC0	Passes: from the Museum of Fine Arts, Boston, by exchange (? – 1964). Earlier history not stated; the MFA co-sponsored the 1935–36 Chanhudaro dig, but the record names no findspot	clevelandart.org/art/1964.104
6	The Met, 59.41.42	Bead, carnelian; culture Indus, findspot Nippur	ca. 2900–2350 BCE	Public domain	Passes: excavated 1957–58 by the Joint Expedition to Nippur; acquired 1958 through the Met's funding of the dig	Met 324872
7	The Met, 57.99.2	Bowl with painted decoration, Damb Sadaat (Balochistan)	ca. early to mid-3rd millennium BCE (Early Harappan)	Public domain	Passes: excavated 1950–51 by the American Museum of Natural History's Afghan Expedition; exchanged to the Met 1957	Met 324704
8	Wikimedia Commons (photo by Gary Todd, 2015); objects in the National Museum, New Delhi	Balance and cubical weights (photograph)	Not dated on the file; the canon dates the type to Mature Harappan	CC0 1.0 (the photograph)	Not stated; objects in India's national collection, no accession number given	Commons file

Checked and not used: Cleveland 1973.160 and 1973.161 (CC0 seals) are first recorded with the dealer William H. Wolff and sold to Cleveland in 1973, so they fail the 1970 test. Met 1978.58, 1986.280 and 1999.22 (animal figures) were acquired after 1970; their provenance was not checked. No CC0 record of an Indus chert weight was found at the Met or Cleveland; use item 8, a drawing of our own, or a link to Harappa.com. The Met's text calls the script "only partially deciphered"; this page says undeciphered, following Rao and colleagues (2009).

Sources

- [Met, Stamp seal 49.40.1; 49.40.2; 49.40.3; 49.40.4; Bead 59.41.42; Bowl 57.99.2](#)
- [Cleveland Open Access API, 1964.104; 1973.160; 1973.161](#)
- [Wikimedia Commons, Harappan \(Indus Valley\) Balance & Weights](#)
- [UNESCO, Archaeological Ruins at Moenjodaro; UNESCO, Dholavira: a Harappan City](#)
- [Harappa.com, Cubical Weights; Weights, Harappa; Excavations at Chanhudaro 1935–36; Chanhudaro in Boston; Who Were the Meluhha?](#)
- [Kenoyer, Vidale and Bhan 1991, Contemporary Stone Beadmaking in Khambhat \(PDF\); Kenoyer 2017, Stone Beads of the Indus Tradition \(PDF\); Kenoyer 1984, Shell Working Industries](#)
- [Petrie 2019, Diversity, variability, adaptation and "fragility" in the Indus Civilization](#)
- [Farmer, Sproat and Witzel 2004 \(PDF\); Rao et al. 2009 \(abstract\); Giosan et al. 2012 \(PNAS\)](#)
- [ThePrint, Khambhat bead-making \(10 April 2023\); Culture and Heritage, Agates of Cambay \(10 January 2023\)](#)
- Wikipedia, for simple facts only: [Indus Valley Civilisation](#); [Indus script](#); [Lothal](#); [Rakhigarhi](#); [Dholavira](#)

Grouping page: The waqf (pious endowment)

A founder gave property away forever, and its rents paid for buildings, lamps, books and their repair for centuries.

Card

Part	Content
Kind	Institution: a commissioning regime in Islamic law (INS044). A founder (<i>wāqif</i>) dedicates property in perpetuity; its income pays for a named charitable purpose
Defined by (who, when)	Muslim jurists, from hadith about perpetual charity; the full legal form probably dates from the 9th century (Wikipedia, "Waqf"). Each foundation is defined by its own deed (<i>waqfiyya</i> , Ottoman <i>vakfiye</i>), validated by a qadi and two witnesses (Isoldi 2025)
Span	Earliest dated deed 876 CE (Wikipedia, "Waqf"); living today, run in most Muslim-majority states by a ministry or directorate of awqaf (Britannica)
Places	Cairo, Damascus, Jerusalem, Istanbul, Edirne, Fez, Algiers, Mecca and Medina, and on across West Asia, North Africa and South Asia (canon INS044 regions WA-MES; AF-EGY; WA-ANA; AS-SAS)
Membership confidence	High for buildings whose deed survives (Sultan Hasan, Khawand Baraka's madrasa, Hürrem Sultan's Jerusalem foundation). Medium for loose objects: a lamp or stand counts as endowed when its own inscription says "dedicated" or "waqf". Low for founders known only from later chronicles (Fatima al-Fihri)
Leaves out	The glassmakers, potters, masons and scribes, almost all unnamed; the peasants and tenants whose rents paid for everything; enslaved people inside founders' households (mamluks were bought as enslaved boys; Hürrem Sultan was taken captive; Sinan was taken in the devshirme levy). Content note where they appear

Part	Content
Rights line	Met objects marked public domain (CC0) and Cleveland CC0 records may be shown with their images. Deeds held in Istanbul and Cairo are link-out only. Buildings via Wikimedia Commons, licence checked per file. Qur'an leaves and the Qur'an stand carry the canon's "sacred" flag: shown with care, as the Qur'an rule in the world brief sets, never cropped through the text. The Aydakin lamp was made for a tomb: content note

Walk

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
1	The deed comes first	A bound endowment charter, dated AH 964 / 1556-57, names Hürrem Sultan's foundation in Jerusalem. It lists a mosque, a madrasa and a soup kitchen, and the shops, mills and estates whose income keeps them running. The learner reads the deed as the brief: who pays, for what, forever.	INS044; PER317; deed: Museum of Turkish and Islamic Arts, Istanbul, inv. 2192 (link-out)	Documented (MWNF record)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
2	A city block paid for by rents	The Süleymaniye in Istanbul was founded in 1550 and inaugurated in 1557, by its inscription. Four madrasas, a hospital, a soup kitchen, a guesthouse, a bath and rent-paying shops surrounded the mosque. Iznik potters tiled it: the earliest known Iznik tiles with tomato-red and emerald green under the glaze.	PER316 (patron); PER319 (Sinan, taken in the devshirme, a forced levy); STY109; MKR057; PLC305; INS042	Documented (Wikipedia, "Süleymaniye Mosque", citing the inscription and deed)
3	The budget line for light	Mamluk deeds paid for maintenance before anything else, then salaries. Only then came food, water, lamps, oil, incense, carpets, brooms and rags (Haarmann 1980). Sultan Hasan's deed, which partly survives, provided for over 500 students, 200 schoolboys and 340 staff.	PER308; POL042; STY104	Documented (Haarmann; Smarthistory)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
4	A lamp that says "dedicated"	Glassmakers in Egypt or Syria, unnamed, blew, enamelled and gilded this lamp around 1325. Its inscription reads "This is what was dedicated by... Ahmad al-Mihmandar" for the madrasa he built in Cairo in 1324–25. The Met thinks it was probably one of several.	OBT024; TEC049; STY104; Met 91.1.1534; Met 17.190.985 (lamp for the tomb of Amir Aydakin, d. 1285)	Documented (inscription); probable ("one of several")
5	Books and furniture in the deed	Hasan ibn Sulaiman al-Isfahani carved this teak Qur'an stand in 1360. Its inscription records it as an endowment to a madrasa. A 14th-century Cairo Qur'an leaf in Cleveland carries a waqf note, marking the book as the foundation's property.	OBT183; GAP024; BEL017; Met 10.218; Cleveland 2013.102	Documented (inscriptions as the museums read them)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
6	Women who endowed	Khawand Baraka endowed her madrasa in Cairo in 1369–70; its deed lists rents and farmland in Egypt and Syria. Hürrem Sultan funded foundations in Istanbul, Jerusalem, Mecca and Edirne (canon PER317). Fatima al-Fihri's founding of the Qarawiyyin in Fez in 859 is argued: see below.	PER317; PER318; PER302; PLC023 (Kairouan, her family's city in the tradition)	Documented (Baraka, Hürrem); contested (Fatima al-Fihri)
7	Repair written into the rules	Ottoman deeds say to spend income "... first [on] repair and maintenance..." (<i>evvela tamir ve termimine</i>). Süleyman's deed asks for repairs without delay; Mehmed II's deed staffs repair workers and a store of materials (Akar 2021). The Süleymaniye was repaired after the fire of 1660 and the earthquake of 1766.	INS044; PER316	Documented (Akar; Wikipedia, "Süleymaniye Mosque")

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
8	States take the endowments	In Algeria, 1844 French legislation let "inalienable" habous property be sold whenever a European was party. From 1881 a conservation committee inside Egypt's waqf ministry restored, and rebuilt, Mamluk mosques. Decree-law 180 of 14 September 1952 abolished Egypt's family endowments.	OCC151 (neighbour: Ottoman state control of antiquities); POL042	Documented (dates); contested (what the takeovers were for)
9	The directorate that still repairs	Turkey's General Directorate of Foundations restored the Süleymaniye in 2007–2010. About 200 people stripped out 1960s cement render and relaid lime-based <i>horasan</i> mortar. The mosque reopened for prayer in November 2010 (Hürriyet; Dünya).	INS044; PER319	Documented, dated to 2010 press

Members. 1 institution (INS044), with 10 people, 4 places and makers, 5 object types and 3 styles or techniques lit by the walk. People: Hürrem Sultan (PER317), Suleiman I (PER316), Mimar Sinan (PER319), Sultan Hasan (PER308), Fatima al-Fihri (PER302, contested), and, without canon IDs yet, Khawand Baraka, Ahmad al-Mihmandar, Amir Aydakin, Sultan Barquq and the maker Hasan ibn Sulaiman al-Isfahani. Places and makers: Iznik and its potteries (PLC305, MKR057), the court studio (INS042), Kairouan (PLC023). Mihrimah Sultan (PER318) commissioned two Sinan mosques, but our sources did not open her deeds; the Süleymaniye, the Sultan Hasan complex and the Qarawiyyin need place IDs.

Object types: mosque lamp (OBT024), Qur'an stand (OBT183), illuminated Qur'an (GAP024), tile, carpet (OBT184 prayer rug as the nearest). Styles and techniques: Mamluk style (STY104), Ottoman classical (STY109), enamelled and gilded glass (TEC049). Polity: the Mamluk Sultanate (POL042). Canon links not yet made: PER231 Jahanara Begum and PER301 Zubaidah bint Ja'far funded caravanserais and pilgrim wells, but our sources did not say whether through waqf.

Neighbours. It defined itself against inheritance and the ruler's treasury: property made waqf could not be sold, inherited or seized, and founders used it partly to protect wealth from confiscation (Hesp ris-Tamuda 2020, citing Saidouni). Wikipedia ("Waqf") notes its close resemblance to the English trust. Parallel groupings elsewhere: the Christian chantry, monastic and hospital foundations, whose English property the crown seized in 1536–41 (OCC059), a mirror of the takeovers in step 8. The Khmer king Jayavarman VII's temples, hospitals and rest houses are listed in inscriptions (PER273). Hindu temple endowments under the Chola kings (POL192; Thanjavur temple, 1010) are a third neighbour; their endowment records still need a source here. Isoldi (2025) notes that scholars link the waqf's development to Byzantine *piae causae* and the Jewish *heqdesh*. We read all of these as parallels of form, not of descent, unless a source shows contact.

Afterlives. Waqf is living law, run in most Muslim-majority states by a ministry (Britannica). In 2007–2010 Turkey's General Directorate of Foundations (Vakıflar Genel M d rl   ) spent 21 million lira on the S leymaniye. Its regional office said earlier restorations ran in 1847–49 and 1959–60, and that the 1960s cement had trapped damp and salts (H rriyet, 9 November 2010). The mosque reopened for prayer at Eid al-Adha in November 2010 (D nya, 16 November 2010). In Fez the Qarawiyyin library was restored from 2012 by the architect Aziza Chaouni, approached by Morocco's Culture Ministry, and reopened in 2016 (AP, 19 April 2016). The lamps became collectors' prizes. In the late 1800s the Parisian craftsman Philippe-Joseph Brocard revived Mamluk enamelling and made many lamp copies (Cleveland 1981.10).

What is argued.

- *Who founded the Qarawiyyin?* One reading: Fatima al-Fihri, a woman from Kairouan, spent her inheritance on the mosque from 859; this is Ibn Abi Zar's account (d. 1310–20), repeated by UNESCO and Guinness. The other: Roger Le Tourneau (1949) and Jonathan Bloom find the two-sisters, two-mosques story too neat. Chafik Benchekroun (2011) reads a Kufic inscription naming Dawud ibn Idris, dated 877, as the mosque's own foundation text, and calls Fatima possibly legendary (Wikipedia, "Fatima al-Fihriya").

- *Colonial takeover: plan or muddle?* The classic account (Ruedy 1967; Powers 1989) has France set out to dismantle *habous* in Algeria, climaxing in the 1844 law. Saidouni and Saidouni (2009, 2023) find two French camps, one for seizure and one for gradual reform, until the 1873 seizure (Hesp ris-Tamuda 2020; Rivisteweb abstract).
- *Why did Egypt abolish family waqf in 1952?* The official reason was misuse and bad management by trustees. Ibrahim al-Bayoumi Ghanem (2021) argues the decree-law, issued a week after the land-reform law, mainly served land reform and weakened the old landowning class (ida2at; Pers e 1953).
- *Conservation or reinvention?* The committee inside Egypt's waqf ministry (1881–1936 under Awqaf) saved Mamluk buildings. It also rebuilt minarets, domes and minbars to its own idea of them; Bakhoun (2021) asks whether this was "conservation" or "reinvention".

Apply (F1.17 Who commissions; also used in F1.10 The Islamic world as a network)

- **Maker (M).** Design one object for a public building that must still work in 200 years: a lamp, a bench or a sign. Write its inscription, what it is made of, and the one repair it will need most. Say who is paid to do that repair.
- **Briefer (B).** Write a one-page "deed" for a commission. List the income that pays for it, the order in which money is spent (repair first, as in the Ottoman deeds), the staff, and what happens if the purpose ends. Then name one way a later state or owner could override it.

Candidate open objects

#	Holder and ID	What and date	Licence (as holder states)	1970 status	Record
1	The Met, 91.1.1534	Mosque lamp of Amir Ahmad al-Mihmandar, glass, blown, enamelled and gilded; ca. 1325 (range 1300–1350)	Public domain (isPublicDomain: true ; Open Access CC0)	Pass: Edward C. Moore bequest, 1891. How it left Cairo is not recorded	Met 444713

#	Holder and ID	What and date	Licence (as holder states)	1970 status	Record
2	The Met, 17.190.985	Mosque lamp for the mausoleum of Amir Aydakin al-'Ala'i al-Bunduqdar; shortly after 1285 (range 1260–1310)	Public domain (CC0)	Pass: gift of J. Pierpont Morgan, 1917. Earlier history not recorded. Funerary setting: content note	Met 447000
3	The Met, 17.190.989	Mosque lamp of Sultan Barquq; ca. 1382–99	Public domain (CC0)	Pass: gift of J. Pierpont Morgan, 1917. Earlier history not recorded	Met 447004
4	The Met, 10.218	Stand for a Qur'an manuscript, teak, carved, painted and inlaid, by Hasan ibn Sulaiman al-Isfahani; dated 761 AH / 1360 CE	Public domain (CC0)	Pass: Rogers Fund, 1910. Canon flag "sacred"	Met 446151
5	Cleveland Museum of Art, 2013.102	Leaf from a Qur'an, Cairo, Mamluk; 1300s; 13 lines of muhaqqaq script with a waqf inscription	CC0	Not shown: the earliest recorded owner is a Christie's sale, 27–28 June 2006; no pre-1970 history. Canon flag "sacred"	clevelandart.org/art/2013.102
6	Cleveland Museum of Art, 1944.236	Mosque lamp, fritware with underglaze painting, Iznik; 1585–95	CC0	Pass: Heeramanek Galleries, sold to Cleveland 1944	clevelandart.org/art/1944.236

#	Holder and ID	What and date	Licence (as holder states)	1970 status	Record
7	Cleveland Museum of Art, 1981.10	Mosque lamp, France, enamelled and gilded glass; late 1800s; from Philippe-Joseph Brocard's collection, possibly made by him	CC0	Chain from the 1800s: Brocard, Demotte, Ispenian, Spink, sold to Cleveland 1981. A European copy, not a looting case	clevelandart.org/art/1981.10

No endowment deed is available under an open licence among the records checked: Hürrem Sultan's charter is link-out only (Museum of Turkish and Islamic Arts, inv. 2192, via MWNF). For the deed step, use the link-out plus a drawing of our own of the deed's parts: founder, property, income, order of spending, staff, trustee, witnesses.

Sources

- The Met: [91.1.1534](#); [17.190.985](#); [17.190.989](#); [10.218](#)
- Cleveland Open Access API: [search "waqf" \(2013.102\)](#); [1944.236](#); [1981.10](#)
- [MWNF Discover Islamic Art: Endowment Charter \(Waqfiyya\) of Haseki Hürrem Sultan](#)
- [Britannica: Waqf](#)
- [Smarthistory: Madrasa and Friday Mosque of Sultan Hasan, Cairo](#)
- Haarmann, "Mamluk Endowment Deeds as a Source for the History of Education in Late Medieval Egypt" (1980), read through a research index
- [Akar, "Repair Conditions of Waqf Buildings in the Waqfiyyas of the Ottoman Period" \(2021\)](#)
- [Bakhoun, "The Waqf in Relation to Maintenance and Repair" \(AUC thesis\)](#)
- [Bakhoun, "The restorations of the Comité ...: conservation or reinvention?" \(Leiden, 2021\)](#)
- Isoldi, "Confluent Waters, Fragmented Powers" (2025), read through a research index
- [Hespéris-Tamuda \(2020\): "Patrimony as Inalienability in Nineteenth-Century Algeria"](#)
- [Saidouni and Saidouni, "La transformation du 'waqf' algérien par l'administration française" \(abstract\)](#)
- [Persée \(1953\): "La suppression du 'wakf ahli' en Egypte"](#)

- [Ghanem, "How did family waqf end in Egypt?" \(ida2at, 2021, Arabic\)](#)
- [Hürriyet \(9 November 2010\)](#); [Dünya \(16 November 2010\)](#); [AP News \(19 April 2016\)](#)
- Wikipedia, for simple facts only: [Waqf](#); [Süleymaniye Mosque](#); [Madrasa of Umm al-Sultan Sha'ban](#); [Fatima al-Fihriya](#)

Grouping page: The Arts and Crafts movement

Designers and makers in Britain argued from the 1850s that how a thing is made matters, then sold that argument at high prices.

Card

Part	Content
Kind	Movement: it named itself (1887), held exhibitions, and had guilds, firms, magazines and members (MOV005)
Defined by (who, when)	The name "Arts and Crafts" was suggested by the bookbinder T. J. Cobden-Sanderson in 1887 for the Arts and Crafts Exhibition Society (INS055). Its roots are older: Ruskin's "The Nature of Gothic" (1853) and Morris, Marshall, Faulkner & Co. (1861). Historians later drew the line from Morris to the Bauhaus (Pevsner, <i>Pioneers of the Modern Movement</i> , 1936; PER471)
Span	c. 1853–1920 as a movement (canon: 1860–1920, approximate); guilds and firms ran on, Morris & Co. to 1940; the brand is still sold in 2026
Places	London (Queen Square, Merton Abbey, Hammersmith), Leek (Staffordshire), Chipping Campden and Broad Campden (Gloucestershire); New York, Chicago, East Aurora and Eastwood (New York State); Stockholm; Vienna; Germany; Ceylon (now Sri Lanka) and India as sources, survey sites and markets

Part	Content
Membership confidence	Documented for the firms, guilds and societies, which kept membership lists and catalogues. Claimed, not chosen, for Indian and Sinhalese makers whose work its writers used as models. Loose for the US and European workshops, which took the name as a style
Leaves out	The women who stitched, wove and designed under the firm's or a man's name; the dyers, printers and weavers paid by the day; the Indian dyers and cultivators behind its indigo and its model textiles; the buyers who could not afford the goods
Rights line	Objects: Met Open Access (CC0) where <code>isPublicDomain</code> is true; Cleveland Open Access (CC0); Art Institute of Chicago public-domain images (data CC0, description text CC BY 4.0). V&A (non-commercial) and William Morris Gallery: link only. Texts by Ruskin (1853), Morris (1882), Birdwood (1880) and Coomaraswamy (1909) are public domain. Today's Morris & Co. products and trademarks (Sanderson Design Group): link only. Decorative arts, so the 1970 provenance test is not applicable

Walk

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
1	Carving in Venice, read in 1853	John Ruskin looked at the uneven carving on Venetian Gothic buildings and read freedom in it. In "The Nature of Gothic" (1853) he wrote: "It is not, truly speaking, the labour that is divided; but the men." Morris reprinted the chapter at his Kelmscott Press in 1892.	PER417, TXT027, STY027, MOV001, MOV007	Text and reprint: documented. That medieval carvers worked freely: interpretive (Ruskin's reading, not evidence from the carvers)
2	A painted cabinet, 1861	Philip Webb designed this pine cabinet; Edward Burne-Jones painted <i>The Backgammon Players</i> on it. It was made in 1861, the year Morris, Marshall, Faulkner & Co. began. The firm was reorganised as Morris & Co. under Morris in 1875.	MKR076, PER418; Met 26.54	Documented

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
3	Who held the needle	Jane Morris worked out stitches for the firm's early embroideries. May Morris ran its embroidery department from 1885. May's <i>Honeysuckle</i> wallpaper (1883) was credited to her father in 1890 and only confirmed as hers around 1909. Kate Faulkner designed printed cottons, tiles and wallpapers for the firm.	PER419, PER420, TEC112; Cleveland 1937.700	Documented (William Morris Gallery; AIC; Cleveland). How many unnamed embroiderers worked for the firm: not known
4	Blue vats at Merton Abbey	Morris read old dye manuals and, in December 1881, noted "reading and noting Persoz on blue-dipping". At Merton Abbey (from 1881) cloth was dyed in indigo, then pattern was bleached out with carved blocks. <i>Cray</i> (1884) needed 34 blocks, more than any other of his river designs.	TEC126, TEC119, MAT041; AIC 1974.419a	Process and dates: documented (Davis; AIC)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
5	"Swinish luxury"	Hand-block printing, natural dyes and hand weaving made the goods costly. Sir Lowthian Bell told Alfred Powell that Morris, decorating Bell's house, cried out: "I spend my life in ministering to the swinish luxury of the rich." W. R. Lethaby printed the story.	MKR076, PER418; Met 23.163.15	That the goods were bought mainly by the middle and upper classes: documented. The quotation: probable (reported third-hand, not dated)
6	Guilds, and a name	Designers and makers organised in guilds from 1882. The Century Guild (A. H. Mackmurdo, 1882) and the Art Workers' Guild (five young architects, 1884) led; C. R. Ashbee's Guild of Handicraft (East London, 1888) moved to Chipping Campden in 1902 and was dissolved in 1907 (the Hart workshop gives 1908). The Arts and Crafts Exhibition Society, founded 1887, opened at the New Gallery on 1 October 1888 and credited the people who executed each piece, not only the firm.	INS055, MOV005	Documented. The Art Workers' Guild shut women out until the second half of the 1900s; May Morris and others set up the Women's Guild of Arts in 1907 (documented)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
7	A tulip panel in New York, a lotus in Chicago	Candace Wheeler saw English art needlework at the 1876 Philadelphia fair. It came from the Royal School of Art Needlework (founded 1872, "Royal" from 1875), set up to employ women; in 1877 she founded New York's Society of Decorative Art on the same lines, and from 1883 her Associated Artists made panels like this one. In 1888 the Decorative Arts Society in Chicago embroidered May Morris's <i>Lotus</i> for Frances Glessner's parlour.	PER144, EVT007, TEC112; Met 28.34.2; AIC 1918.298	Documented (RSN; Met; AIC)

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
8	Workshops that took the name	Elbert Hubbard founded Roycroft at East Aurora in 1895, with almost 500 people by 1910. Gustav Stickley's <i>Craftsman</i> magazine ran from 1901 to 1916; his Eastwood workshops used hand methods and woodworking machinery. Sweden's Friends of Handicraft (1874) and Vienna's Wiener Werkstätte (1903) worked on parallel lines.	STY035, MKR077	Documented. How far each drew on the English movement rather than local reform: contested

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
9	Indigo, tussar and the Indian craftsman	British writers made Indian hand work a model, and a display. Birdwood (1880) praised it as timeless; in 1886, 34 Indian artisans, most of them prisoners from the Central Jail at Agra, were put to work in view at London's Colonial and Indian Exhibition; Thomas Wardle, Morris's dyeing partner at Leek (1875–77), imported Indian tussar silk for the women of the Leek Embroidery Society (1879). From the other side, Ananda Coomaraswamy printed <i>Mediaeval Sinhalese Art</i> at Ashbee's Essex House Press (1908), and <i>The Indian Craftsman</i> (1909) carried Ashbee's foreword.	PER242, TXT082, EVT005, PER246, TXT080, MAT041, OCC137, NET055, MOV081	Documented events. Extraction or exchange: contested (see What is argued). Content note: the 1886 display used incarcerated men as living exhibits

Members. 20 people, 14 makers' bodies, 5 places and 8 objects are lit on this walk. People: John Ruskin, William Morris, Jane Morris, May Morris, Kate Faulkner, Philip Webb, Edward Burne-Jones, T. J. Cobden-Sanderson, Walter Crane (the Exhibition Society's founding president), W. R. Lethaby, A. H. Mackmurdo, C. R. Ashbee, George Hart, Candace Wheeler, Frances Glessner, Gustav Stickley, Elbert Hubbard, Elizabeth Wardle, Thomas Wardle and Ananda Coomaraswamy (with Ethel Mairet, below). Makers' bodies: Morris & Co.

(MKR076), the Royal School of Art Needlework, the Century Guild, the Art Workers' Guild, the Guild of Handicraft, the Arts and Crafts Exhibition Society (INS055), the Women's Guild of Arts, the Leek Embroidery Society, New York's Society of Decorative Art, the Chicago Decorative Arts Society, Roycroft, the Craftsman Workshops, Friends of Handicraft and the Wiener Werkstätte (MKR077). Places: Merton Abbey, Leek, Chipping Campden, East Aurora, Eastwood. Birdwood (PER242) is a neighbour, not a member: he wrote about Indian makers for British designers. Ethel Mairet married Coomaraswamy in 1902, recorded Ceylon's crafts with him until 1907, and began weaving and dyeing in 1909; she later built a weaving workshop, Gospels, at Ditchling (completed 1920).

Neighbours. It defined itself against the goods of the Great Exhibition (EVT001, 1851) and the South Kensington design-reform system that followed (INS052, PER413), though it borrowed South Kensington's collections of Indian and Persian textiles. It grew from the Gothic Revival (STY027) and the Pre-Raphaelite circle (MOV001). Parallel groupings: the private press movement (MOV007); the Wiener Werkstätte (MKR077); the Deutscher Werkbund (MOV011); Swadeshi in India (MOV081, from 1905), which made hand-spinning a political act; the Bengal School (MOV082); Mingei in Japan (MOV096); the school at Rotorua under Āpirana Ngata (INS085, from 1926). The phrase "arts and crafts" also travelled into US law through the Indian Arts and Crafts Board (INS014, 1935).

Afterlives. Hermann Muthesius studied English houses at the German embassy in London (1896–1904) and published *Das englische Haus* (1904–05); the Deutscher Werkbund formed in 1907 (MOV011). Gropius's 1919 Bauhaus pamphlet called for "a new guild of craftsmen, without the class distinctions which raise an arrogant barrier between craftsman and artist" (INS057, TXT032). Scholars argue that Mingei drew on Ruskin and Morris (MOV096, PER209). In Chipping Campden, the Hart gold and silversmiths still work in the Silk Mill where the Guild of Handicraft worked; in September 2026 their site named David Hart and the fourth generation, William and Julian. Morris & Co. is now a brand of Sanderson Design Group: in the year to 31 January 2026 it earned £18.5m, up 3%, with rugs and homewares licensed to Ruggable and Williams Sonoma. The movement's words ("handcrafted", "artisanal", "heritage") are now common in marketing for goods made at scale.

What is argued.

- *A luxury trade or a real critique?* One reading: the firm's own prices showed that hand work under capitalism became a luxury; Morris's work "became popular with the middle and upper classes, despite his wish to create a democratic art" (Wikipedia, "Arts and Crafts movement"; the Lethaby anecdote). The other reading: the lasting

product was the argument, not the goods. The Exhibition Society named executants (Hart, BRANCH), and the Bauhaus took up the call for a guild without class barriers (Wikipedia, "Bauhaus"). Both readings are shown.

- *Who made the movement?* The older story centres Morris, Crane, Ashbee and Lethaby, as the canon's "defined by" field still does. Zoë Thomas (*Women Art Workers and the Arts and Crafts Movement*, 2020) argues that women art workers were "central players" who revived the movement in the Edwardian years. The Honeysuckle case shows how credit moved to the famous man (William Morris Gallery).
- *Extraction or exchange with India?* Extraction reading: British writers fixed Indian makers as timeless (Birdwood, 1880); 34 men, mostly Agra prisoners, were displayed working in 1886 (Briefel, BRANCH, drawing on Saloni Mathur, *India by Design*, 2007); Wardle went to Bengal in 1885, at the government's invitation, to reform silk farming and reeling; and Bengal's indigo system rested on planters' coercive contracts (OCC137). Exchange reading: Morris wrote in 1882 that "from the remotest times the whole art [of dyeing] was thoroughly understood in India" and modelled his block printing on Indian chintz (Davis); Coomaraswamy used Arts and Crafts presses and Ashbee's foreword to argue that British rule had weakened India's craft guilds (*The Indian Craftsman*, 1909), and McGowan (2009) shows craft surveys feeding Indian nationalist thinking. We read both as true at once: the exchange ran through colonial power. Where Merton Abbey bought its indigo is not recorded in the sources we opened.
- *Is Mingei its child?* Yuko Kikuchi (2004) argues Mingei theory was "highly eclectic" with "strong influences" from Ruskin and Morris; the movement presented itself as Japanese in origin. Summarised in Santamaria Hergueta (2023). Contested.

Apply (F1.19, with F1.18 and F1.20)

- **Maker (M).** Write the credit line for one piece of your own work in the 1888 Exhibition Society manner: every person who designed, dyed, printed, stitched or finished it, and who supplied the material.
- **Briefer (B).** A client wants "artisanal" on the pack. Write the three questions the brief must answer first: who makes it and by what share of hand and machine; what they are paid; and where the dye or raw material comes from.

Candidate open objects

#	Holder and ID	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence as stated	1970 status	Record
1	The Met, 26.54	<i>The Backgammon</i> Players cabinet; Philip Webb (designer), Burne-Jones (artist), Morris, Marshall, Faulkner & Co. (manufacturer); painted pine, oil on leather	1861	Public domain (<code>isPublicDomain: true</code> ; Met Open Access CC0)	Not applicable (decorative arts); acquired 1926 (Rogers Fund)	Met 195456
2	The Met, 23.163.15	<i>Bird</i> , woven wool length; designed by William Morris, Morris & Company	designed 1878	Public domain (CC0)	Not applicable; purchased 1923	Met 221485
3	The Met, 23.163.4a	<i>Pink and Rose</i> wallpaper; designed by Morris, Morris & Company, printed by Jeffrey & Co. (the firm's wallpapers were printed outside its own works)	ca. 1890 (1885–95)	Public domain (CC0)	Not applicable; purchased 1923	Met 337071
4	Art Institute of Chicago, 1974.419a	<i>Cray</i> , block-printed cotton; Morris, Morris & Co., Merton Abbey; 34 blocks	design 1884, made 1884–1917	Public domain; data CC0, description CC BY 4.0	Not applicable; given 1974 by Martha Batchelder	AIC 47661
5	Art Institute of Chicago, 1918.298	<i>Lotus</i> door curtain; design attributed to May Morris, Morris & Co.; embroidered by the Decorative Arts Society, Chicago	design by 1888, made 1888	Public domain; data CC0, description CC BY 4.0	Not applicable; Glessner family c. 1888, given 1918	AIC 74514
6	Art Institute of Chicago, 1988.108	Border for a table cover or valance; design attributed to May Morris, Morris & Co.; silk embroidery on cotton	design 1890s	Public domain; data CC0	Not applicable; bought from Meg Andrews, 1988	AIC 71294

#	Holder and ID	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence as stated	1970 status	Record
7	Cleveland Museum of Art, 1937.700	<i>Peony</i> , printed cotton; Kate Faulkner (designer), provenance "Morris and Company"	1920 (printing; Faulkner died 1898)	CC0	Not applicable; gift 1937	clevelandart.org/art/1937.700
8	The Met, 28.34.2	<i>Tulips panel</i> ; Candace Wheeler (designer), Associated Artists (maker), ground by Cheney Brothers; silk and metallic cloth, appliqué and embroidery	1883–87	Public domain (CC0)	Not applicable; gift of the Wheeler family 1928	Met 15971

Checked and not usable: the Met's *Strawberry Thief* 23.163.11 (printed 1917–23) and *Brother Rabbit* 23.163.5 are `isPublicDomain: false`; the Met's May Morris valance 2017.178.2 is not public domain; AIC's May Morris *Honeysuckle Fire Screen* 2018.846 and *Vine Leaf* 2018.844 and the AIC Stickley settle 1971.748 are not public domain; the V&A's *Strawberry Thief* is link only. Cleveland also holds Morris's *Tulip* (1937.579, CC0), recorded as "roller printed cotton" dated 1875; whether that is an authorised machine print is unchecked. No open Indian textile is attached here: use the NET055 and TEC120 records, or a drawing of our own of the discharge-printing steps.

Sources

- [Met Open Access API \(object 195456 and the others listed above\)](#)
- Art Institute of Chicago API: [Lotus](#); [Cray](#); [Border](#); [Settle](#)
- Cleveland Open Access API: [Tulip 1937.579](#); [Peony 1937.700](#)
- [Victorian Web, Hewison, "The Artist and Society" \(Ruskin quotation\)](#); [Victorian Web, "Morris & Co."](#); [Victorian Web, review of Zoë Thomas](#)
- [The Motor House, Peter Burman on Rounton](#)
- [Virginia Davis, "William Morris and Indigo Discharge Printing"](#); [nonsite.org, "The Poetics of Indigo Discharge Printing"](#)
- [William Morris, "The Lesser Arts of Life" \(1882\)](#)

- [William Morris Gallery, Honeysuckle wallpaper](#); [Art Institute of Chicago, "May Morris: Designer and Advocate"](#)
- [Royal School of Needlework, Our history](#); [Met press release, Candace Wheeler retrospective \(2001\)](#)
- [Imogen Hart, "On the Arts and Crafts Exhibition Society", BRANCH](#); [Aviva Briefel, "On the 1886 Colonial and Indian Exhibition", BRANCH](#)
- [Chipping Campden History Society, C R Ashbee and the Guild of Handicraft](#); [Hart gold and silversmiths, Our story](#)
- [Birdwood, The Industrial Arts of India \(Internet Archive\)](#); [Coomaraswamy, The Indian Craftsman \(1909, Internet Archive\)](#)
- [Abigail McGowan, "The Culture of Difference" \(2009\)](#); [Santamaria Hergueta, "Approaches to the analysis of Mingei in Japan" \(2023\)](#)
- [Sanderson Design Group, Annual Report and Accounts 2026](#)
- Wikipedia, for simple facts only: [Arts and Crafts movement](#); [Art Workers' Guild](#); [Roycroft](#); [Gustav Stickley](#); [Friends of Handicraft](#); [Thomas Wardle](#); [Leek Embroidery Society](#); [George Birdwood](#); [Ethel Mairet](#); [Hermann Muthesius](#); [Bauhaus](#)

Cited but not opened: Saloni Mathur, *India by Design* (2007), through Briefel; Yuko Kikuchi, *Japanese Modernisation and Mingei Theory* (2004), through Santamaria Hergueta; Lethaby's life of Morris, through Burman.

Grouping page: The Middle Horizon (Andes)

Tapestry tunics, a staff-holding god and knotted cords spread across the Andes about 600–1000 CE; whether an empire spread them is argued.

Card

Part	Content
Kind	Horizon (HOR002), and the period of the same name (PRD189). It is an archaeologists' time term, not a people or a state. It opens onto two polities, Wari (POL058) and Tiwanaku (POL059), and one shared style (STY065)

Part	Content
Defined by (who, when)	John H. Rowe's Andean chronology of the 1960s, which alternates "horizons" of widespread style with "intermediate periods" (canon HOR001–HOR003). Dorothy Menzel's 1964 monograph split it into ceramic epochs (Middle Horizon 1–4, with sub-phases such as 1A and 1B). Ann Pollard Rowe (2024) re-dates the ceramics Menzel gave to Middle Horizon 3, so the end of the horizon is itself being redrawn. Luis Lumbreras's rival scheme (PRD192) calls the same centuries the "Wari Empire" stage
Span	About 600–1000 CE, the conventional range (Jennings 2006; Conlee and others 2021; the Met). Tiwanaku starts earlier: UNESCO gives 400–900 CE for its flourishing and a collapse in the first half of the 12th century
Places	Wari: the capital near Ayacucho, Peru; Conchopata nearby; Pikillacta near Cusco; Cerro Baúl in Moquegua; Huaca del Loro in Nasca; El Castillo de Huarmey on the north coast. Tiwanaku: the capital by Lake Titicaca, Bolivia, with colonies in Moquegua. Many museum textiles come from dry south-coast graves in Ica and Nasca. None of these places has a canon ID yet
Membership confidence	Documented for excavated finds at Wari and Tiwanaku sites. Probable for museum textiles labelled "Wari" by style, with no findspot. Contested at the edges: museums label the same hat type "Wari", "Tiwanaku style" or "Tiwanaku or Wari", and Cleveland keeps modern fakes of Wari-style pots

Part	Content
Leaves out	The makers' own names for their polities: "Wari" and "Tiwanaku" are modern site names. The weavers, spinners and dyers, none named. Coastal and highland communities who lived alongside or under Wari. The Aymara (COM138), for whom Tiwanaku is ancestral. What the staff-holding figure meant; the Met says the role of such beings "remains unknown"
Rights line	Met, Cleveland and Art Institute of Chicago records listed below are CC0 or public domain and may be shown. Many Wari textiles came from burials: show them only with origin and a content note. Never show human remains, mummy bundles or tomb photographs, including El Castillo de Huarmey. Tiwanaku site and Gateway of the Sun: link out to UNESCO. Taquile and Chinchero weavers: link out to their own published pages; photographs only with the weavers' permission

Walk

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
1	Eight winged figures on a tunic	Two woven panels, stitched together, make a sleeveless, knee-length tunic. Weavers set eight winged feline figures in columns; each holds a staff and carries a patterned cloth. The warp is cotton, the weft camelid hair, and cochineal gives the magenta.	WS-007 (Met 2021.146); TEC092; MAT064; MAT056; MAT043; STY065	Structure and materials: documented (Met record). What the figures meant: not known; the Met says their role "remains unknown"

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
2	Two weavers on one piece	Wari tunics took so much work that sometimes two weavers shared one piece, the Met says. The Art Institute of Chicago counts Wari tunics among the highest thread counts of any handwoven cloth. Figures are squeezed narrower towards the sides, following a design rule.	WS-007; AIC 1956.95; Cleveland 1949.12; TEC092; STY065	Labour and thread counts: documented. That the state ran the weaving: argued. The Met says scholars believe production "was supervised by imperial administrators"; Jennings's low-power model points instead to rival elite houses
3	A name archaeologists gave to time	"Middle Horizon" is a label from John Rowe's Andean chronology, not an ancient name. Rowe named "horizons" when one style spread widely, with "intermediate periods" between. Dorothy Menzel's 1964 study divided it by pottery epochs; its end is being re-dated (A. P. Rowe 2024).	HOR002; PRD189; HOR001; HOR003; PRD192	Origin of the term: documented. About 600–1000 CE: probable, the conventional range. The end date: contested

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
4	The staff god at two capitals	A front-facing figure holds a staff in each hand. At Tiwanaku it is carved at the centre of the Gateway of the Sun's frieze. At Conchopata, near Wari, potters painted it on ceramic vessels. Isbell reads this as "the initial introduction of Tiahuanaco imagery into Ayacucho".	POL059; POL058; CIV035; CIV036; BEL038; Conchopata and Tiwanaku (no canon IDs; proposed)	Shared image: documented. Who borrowed from whom: argued. The Met says Ayacucho elites adopted Tiwanaku images; Moseley says the two "are not borrowing anything from each other" at their Moquegua border
5	Stone cramps and raised fields at Tiwanaku	Tiwanaku masons cut andesite and sandstone blocks and joined some with I-shaped metal cramps. Around the lake, farmers raised planting beds between water channels, called suka qullu. UNESCO counts almost 50,000 such fields.	POL059; CIV035; COM138; Tiwanaku (UNESCO 2000; no canon ID)	Masonry and fields: documented. Who organised the fields: argued. Kolata (1991) says the state ran them; Erickson (1993) says local communities built and kept them

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
6	A planned town and a burned brewery	At Pikillacta, near Cusco, Wari builders laid out about 25 hectares of walled compounds. At Cerro Baúl, far south, a brewery held about 1,800 litres of chicha of maize and molle berries. When Wari people left, they feasted, broke 28 fine vessels and burned the buildings.	POL058; OBT075 (kero); Pikillacta and Cerro Baúl (no canon IDs; proposed)	Finds: documented (McEwan; Moseley, Williams and Nash 2005). Read as imperial administration and state feasting: contested (see below)
7	Knots wrapped in colour	Wari cord-keepers wrapped coloured thread around pendant cords before knotting. Three Wari khipus are radiocarbon-dated to 780–1024 CE (Cherkinsky and Urton 2014). About fourteen more came from excavations at El Castillo de Huarmey between 2013 and 2016.	OBT139; TEC104; INV005; MKR024 (later Inca keepers); links to F1.5	Wari khipus as the earliest known securely dated khipus: probable. A Caral cord claim is not securely published (INV005, low). Whether khipus are writing: argued; see F1.5

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
8	Hats, graves and fakes	Wari and Tiwanaku weavers knotted four-cornered pile hats, which probably marked a wearer's rank. <i>Content note:</i> many such hats and tunics came from graves, and records rarely say which. Looters have dug around El Castillo de Huarmey for decades; Cleveland keeps 20th-century fakes of Wari-style pots.	Met 33.149.101; Cleveland 1947.291; Met 1994.35.158; Cleveland 1955.173 (forgeries)	Hats and rank: probable (the Met says "likely"). Burial origin: probable for most south-coast pieces, stated on few records. Looting: documented

#	Step title	What the learner sees and reads	Nodes	Claim and confidence
9	Weavers on Taquile and at Chinchero	Weavers on Taquile, in Lake Titicaca, still weave calendar belts and knit chullo hats. UNESCO proclaimed this practice in 2005 and inscribed it in 2008. Cusco's Centre for Traditional Textiles, founded in 1996, listed ten weaving communities, Chinchero among them, in September 2026.	PRA051; PRA053; COM137; COM138; TEC085	Living practice: documented, dated to source. We read it as a living afterlife of Andean weaving, not of Wari itself. No direct line from Wari to these weavers is claimed

Members. In the canon: 1 horizon (HOR002) and its period (PRD189); 1 style (STY065); 2 polities (POL058 Wari, POL059 Tiwanaku) and their 2 civilisation names (CIV036, CIV035), both under the Andean label (CIV021); 3 object types (OBT075 kero, OBT139 khipu, OBT048 feather cloak, for Wari feathered panels); 4 techniques (TEC092 tapestry weaving, TEC104 khipu construction, TEC122 tie-resist dyeing, TEC109 featherwork); 3 materials (MAT064 camelid fibre, MAT056 cotton, MAT043 cochineal); 1 "earliest known" row (INV005 khipu). That is 18 canon nodes. No place is in the canon yet; six are proposed: Huari (Ayacucho), Tiwanaku, Conchopata, Pikillacta, Cerro Baúl and El Castillo de Huarmey. Eight open objects are listed below. The key members are the tapestry tunics and four-cornered hats, because they carry the shared style and the labour argument together.

Neighbours. Before it: the Early Horizon of Chavín (HOR001, STY064) and the Early Intermediate Period of Nasca (ARC206) and Moche (ARC207, POL057); Moche-Wari style pieces sit on that seam. After it: the Late Intermediate Period, with Chimor (POL060) and Sicán (ARC209), then the Late Horizon of the Inca (HOR003, POL061, STY066). The Inca

state's cloth-makers, the Aqllakuna (MKR023), and its khipu keepers (MKR024) inherit two Middle Horizon crafts. Rival frame: Lumbreras's stage scheme (PRD192) names the same centuries by a Wari empire, not by a style. Parallel elsewhere, with no ranking: the Mississippian Ideological Interaction Sphere (HOR007), another shared iconography whose political meaning is argued.

Afterlives. Taquile weaving was proclaimed by UNESCO in 2005 and inscribed in 2008. Men there knit chullo hats and weavers make calendar belts that record the ritual and farming year (PRA051). The Centre for Traditional Textiles of Cusco was founded in 1996 by Andean weavers and supporters. In September 2026 its site listed ten communities, including Chinchero, "the birthplace of the CTTC" (PRA053). Raised fields came back in the 1980s: Erickson's project rebuilt fields with Quechua communities at Huatta, Coata and Capachica from 1981 to 1986. By 1989 hundreds of families had adopted them, Erickson reports (1993). Bandy (2005, as summarised on Wikipedia) reports that farmers stopped once projects ended in the 1990s. Remembered: Tiwanaku became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2000. Cleveland's 2012–13 exhibition called Wari "widely regarded today as ancient Peru's first empire". The Met showed WS-007 in "Weaving Abstraction in Ancient and Modern Art" (5 March–16 June 2024). Sold: Wari cloth has long fed the art market, and so have fakes.

What is argued.

- *Was Wari an empire?* One reading says yes: an expansive state with planned administrative centres such as Pikillacta and Viracochapampa, and roads (Schreiber, Isbell and McEwan, as summarised by Jennings 2024). Conlee and colleagues (2021) read compounds, a D-shaped temple and non-local burials at Huaca del Loro as Wari colonisation of Nasca. Moseley, Williams and Nash (2005) call Cerro Baúl a Wari colony and read its brewery as state feasting. The other reading says the evidence was fitted to expectation. Jennings (2006) argues the model of administrative centres ruling through reciprocity "fit[s] our expectations" more than the data. Jennings (2024) keeps the word "empire" but describes low power: rival elite houses and small gatherings, and a heterogeneous horizon of shared ideas, objects and people.
- *Was Tiwanaku a state that ran its fields?* Kolata (1991) argues state authority organised raised-field farming, with hierarchical ties between city and countryside; UNESCO calls Tiwanaku "the capital of a powerful empire". Erickson (1993) argues farming was organised "at the local level": the fields predate the state and continued after it. Wikipedia's summary of later work (Janusek 2004; Bandy 2013) describes a federation of communities or a network of powerful lineages. It notes no defensive architecture, state roads or princely burials.

- *Did the state weave the tunics?* The Met's label says scholars believe production "was supervised by imperial administrators"; canon STY065 reads the standard designs the same way. Jennings's low-power model would place fine cloth among competing elite houses and gift-giving instead. That extension to cloth is our reading, not his stated claim.
- *Where did the shared image come from, and does sharing mean rule?* The Met says Ayacucho elites adopted Tiwanaku images and beliefs; Isbell dates this at Conchopata to Middle Horizon 1A. At Cerro Baúl, Moseley says the two polities "are not borrowing anything from each other". Shared iconography alone does not show imperial control; both sides accept this and argue from other evidence.

Apply (F1.7 The Americas, read through fibre; khipu shared with F1.5, cloth with F1.18)

- **Maker (M).** Take the column of figures on WS-007 and redraw one figure on squared paper at three widths: full, half and quarter. Keep every part of the figure; only squeeze it. Then write two sentences on what survives compression and what becomes unreadable.
- **Briefer (B).** A client wants a "Wari-inspired" textile range. Write a one-page brief. It must name the source objects and their holders, carry the burial content note, and state both readings of Wari. It must route any weaving through a named living community, such as the Cusco centre, with credit and pay terms. It must not claim the weavers descend from Wari.

Candidate open objects

1. **Tunic (WS-007).** The Met, 2021.146; 650–1000 CE; Wari; cotton, camelid hair. Licence: public domain (`isPublicDomain: true` ; Met Open Access). 1970: pass with caveat. The record gives "[André Emmerich Gallery, New York, 1960s]; Guido and Nelly di Tella, Buenos Aires, ca. 1960s–2013; Claudia Quentin, New York, 2013–2021". It left Peru before 1970 on the record, but the Met brackets the 1960s step, marking it unconfirmed. Findspot not stated. [Record](#)
2. **Tunic.** Art Institute of Chicago, 1956.95; 600–800 CE; Wari; origin given as Nazca Valley. Licence: public domain (`is_public_domain: true`); data CC0, description field CC BY. 1970: pass. "Pablo Soldi, Ica, Peru, by May 21, 1956 ... sold to the Art Institute of Chicago, 1956", so it left Peru in 1956. Content note: probably from a south-coast grave; the record does not say. [Record](#)
3. **Tunic with Profile Animal and Human Heads.** Cleveland Museum of Art, 1949.12; c. 700–1100; Wari, south coast; camelid fibre and cotton tapestry. Licence: CC0. 1970: pass on accession year (1949). The record gives only "Gift of John Wise", with no earlier history.

[Record](#)

4. **Tapestry Square Panel.** Cleveland Museum of Art, 1957.495; c. 700–1100; Wari, south coast; interlocked tapestry, wool and cotton. Licence: CC0. 1970: pass on accession year (1957). The record gives only "Gift of John Wise in memory of Leonard C. Hanna Jr." [Record](#)
5. **Four-Cornered Hat.** The Met, 33.149.101; 7th–9th century; Wari; camelid hair, cotton. Licence: public domain. 1970: pass; "Gift of George D. Pratt, 1933". Earlier history and findspot not stated. [Record](#)
6. **Four-Cornered Hat.** Cleveland Museum of Art, 1947.291; c. 700–1100; labelled "Wari Culture, Tiwanaku Style"; needle network with cut pile. Licence: CC0. 1970: pass on accession year (1947); "Gift of John Wise", no earlier history. Useful for step 8 as a label case. [Record](#)
7. **Four-Cornered Hat.** The Met, 1994.35.158; 500–900 CE; labelled "Tiwanaku or Wari"; camelid fibre. Licence: public domain. 1970: unknown. "Bequest of Arthur M. Bullowa, 1993", and the provenance field is empty. Hold for display until its history before 1970 is found; use as a link-out case on attribution. [Record](#)
8. **Kero (beaker).** The Met, 1978.412.214; 500–1000 CE; Tiwanaku; wood. Licence: public domain. 1970: pass on the credit line, "Purchase, Nelson A. Rockefeller Gift, 1968". Earlier history and findspot not stated. [Record](#)

Not listed but checked: Cleveland 1955.173, "Wari-style Vessels", 20th-century forgeries, CC0, gift of William R. Carlisle, 1955 ([record](#)). No open record of a Wari khipu was found at the Met, Cleveland or AIC. For step 7, link out to Dumbarton Oaks and the Museo de Arte de Lima, or use a drawing of our own of a wrapped pendant cord.

Sources

- The Met: [Tunic 2021.146](#); [Hat 1994.35.158](#); [API 308121](#); [API 310659](#)
- [Art Institute of Chicago API, artwork 2091](#)
- Cleveland Open Access API: [search "Wari"](#); [1949.12](#); [1957.495](#); [1947.291](#)
- [Wari: Lords of the Ancient Andes \(Cleveland Museum of Art, 2012–13\)](#)
- [José Ochatoma Paravicino, "Wari Imperial Art", Heilbrunn Timeline \(2025\)](#)
- [Jennings, "Understanding Middle Horizon Peru", Latin American Antiquity \(2006\)](#); [Jennings, "Wari: Imperialism, Low Power, and Globalization" \(2024\)](#)
- [Conlee and others, "Early imperialism in the Andes: Wari colonisation of Nasca", Antiquity \(2021\)](#)
- ["Burning down the brewery" \(EurekAlert, 14 November 2005\)](#)

- [Urton, "From Middle Horizon cordkeeping to the rise of Inka khipus", Antiquity \(2014\); Cherkinsky and Urton, "Radiocarbon chronology of Andean khipus" \(2014\); Splitstoser and Giersz, "Wari-Style Khipus from El Castillo de Huarmey" \(tDAR\)](#)
- [Written in Knots \(Dumbarton Oaks, 2019\); Wari Khipus \(MALI, Google Arts & Culture\)](#)
- [Staff God and Profile Attendants, Conchopata \(UCLA; Isbell\)](#)
- [Kolata, "The Technology and Organization of Agricultural Production in the Tiwanaku State" \(1991\); Erickson, "The Social Organization of Prehispanic Raised Field Agriculture" \(1993\)](#)
- [UNESCO, Tiwanaku \(2000\); UNESCO, Taquile and its textile art](#)
- [Ann Pollard Rowe, "Redefining the End of the Middle Horizon: Part 1", Ñawpa Pacha \(2024\)](#)
- [Centro de Textiles Tradicionales del Cusco](#) and [its communities page](#)
- Wikipedia, for simple facts only: [Pikillaqta](#); [Wari culture](#); [El Castillo de Huarmey](#); [Staff God](#); [Tiwanaku polity](#); [Pre-Inca cultures](#)